

Cosmin Peste

07472545546 | London | me@cosminpeste.com | www.cosminpeste.com

Career Profile

A highly experienced data engineering leader with over seven years in designing and delivering data platforms across cloud-native environments. Currently a Data Engineering Delivery Manager at AXA, responsible for the delivery output of data engineering teams within the Finance Centre of Excellence, combining technical delivery, people leadership, and acting as the bridge between business stakeholders and engineering teams.

Proven track record in delivering complex regulatory projects, platform migrations, and data infrastructure improvements using Azure Databricks, Data Factory, and modern data stack technologies. Expert in Python, PySpark, SQL, and CI/CD practices, with deep experience in both batch and real-time data processing.

Skilled in translating business requirements into robust technical solutions while protecting engineering time and capacity. Drives quality through coding standards, mentorship, and adoption of emerging technologies including AI-assisted development. Experienced in stakeholder management, cross-functional collaboration, and navigating regulatory requirements for financial services.

Strong focus on data quality, governance, cost efficiency, and enabling self-serve analytics. Adept at working directly with technology vendors to influence product direction and resolve platform-level challenges. Well-suited to leading data initiatives in fast-paced, product-led, regulated environments.

Employment History

July 2026 - Present

Data Engineering Delivery Manager, AXA, London, www.axa.co.uk

- Manage the day-to-day delivery of a team of data engineers within the AXA UK Finance Centre of Excellence, ensuring data assets are curated to standardised formats and meet all data management and quality frameworks and policies.
- Oversee the migration of Finance CoE data assets to the Azure Data Lake, driving the creation of reusable, strategic data pipelines that enable efficient access to data across the broader delivery teams.
- Build cross-functional relationships with Data Science, Insights, and Product Owners to understand data requirements and translate them into engineering delivery plans and standardised reporting solutions.
- Lead planning, prioritisation, and delegation of work across the team, balancing capacity against project deadlines and business objectives while mentoring engineers on Spark, Databricks, and best practices.
- Support stakeholders with communication and knowledge management strategies, educating and empowering data consumers on governance policies and practices.
- Collaborate with peers across the business to shape and deliver inputs to the overarching data strategy for advanced modelling and reporting on Azure.

October 2021 - July 2026

Lead Data Engineer, AXA, London, www.axa.co.uk

- Led a team of data engineers across three product squads, managing workload distribution, capacity planning, and delivery timelines while protecting engineering focus from operational distractions.
- Acted as interim Data Delivery Manager, coordinating priorities across multiple engineering teams and serving as the primary interface between business stakeholders and technical teams.
- Delivered critical regulatory reporting projects including FCA Consumer Duty and FCA Consumer Credit, working across technical implementation and stakeholder alignment to verify solutions met regulatory requirements.
- Led the Unity Catalog migration project, moving legacy data assets to modern technologies to unlock improved governance, performance, and cost benefits.

- Established and enforced coding standards across teams, driving quality improvements through code reviews, technical upskilling, and adoption of AI-assisted development tools.
- Built and maintained scalable data pipelines using Azure Databricks, Data Factory, and Event Hubs, improving data processing speed and system reliability for core business domains.
- Engaged directly with Databricks to pilot new features, advocate for team needs, and resolve technical challenges at the platform level.
- Implemented data quality frameworks and automated monitoring, reducing data incidents and building confidence in analytics outputs.
- Championed CI/CD best practices using Azure DevOps and Git, improving release consistency and deployment velocity.

**January 2019 -
October 2021**

Senior Data Engineer, Experian, London, www.experian.com

- Developed Single Customer View (SCV) solutions using SQL and Python to support personalised customer insights and reporting.
- Designed and maintained robust ETL pipelines, ensuring reliable data integration across multiple sources and systems.
- Automated key data workflows using Jenkins, improving delivery speed and reducing manual effort.
- Refactored and optimised legacy SQL code to dynamic, reusable scripts, enhancing performance and maintainability.
- Wrote efficient queries on large-scale datasets and implemented automated test suites to ensure data quality and pipeline stability.
- Collaborated with internal teams and stakeholders to translate business requirements into actionable data solutions.

**September 2018 -
January 2019**

Data Analyst, Experian, London, www.experian.com

- Gathered and translated business requirements from stakeholders into actionable data specifications and deliverables.
- Identified and resolved data quality issues, contributing to more accurate reporting and improved decision-making.
- Analysed business processes and recommended data-driven improvements to enhance operational efficiency.
- Designed and implemented new batch data processes for client onboarding and recurring data delivery.
- Supported the development of scalable data solutions by aligning client needs with internal data capabilities.

Education

2014 - 2018

BSc Computer Science, Coventry University, Coventry, UK

Certificates

Microsoft Azure Fundamentals AZ-900, Microsoft, (Grade - Pass)

Microsoft Azure Data Fundamentals DP-900, Microsoft, (Grade - Pass)

Level 3, Microsoft Excel Advanced Spreadsheets, British Computer Society, (88%)

Oracle Databases: Introduction to MySQL, Oracle, London, (Grade - Pass)

Cisco IT Essentials: PC Hardware and Software, Cisco Network Academy, (Grade - Pass)

Skills

Programming & Data Processing

- Python (PySpark, Pandas), SQL (Oracle, MySQL, T-SQL, PostgreSQL), HTML, CSS, JavaScript (Node.js)

Data Engineering & Platforms

- Azure Databricks, Azure Data Factory, Azure Data Lake, Apache Spark, Unity Catalog, Docker, Jenkins

Cloud & DevOps

- Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipelines, Git (GitHub, SVN), Bitbucket

Data Governance & Metadata Management

- Collibra, Unity Catalog

Data Visualisation & BI

- Power BI, Tableau

Collaboration & Agile Tools

- Jira, Confluence, SharePoint

Personal Projects

2025 - MapVista

Built an AI-powered trip planning platform that helps users design personalised travel itineraries through conversational interactions. Developed the full stack using modern web technologies and integrated AI agent capabilities to provide intelligent recommendations and dynamic route planning. The project involved vibe coding sessions that strengthened both frontend and backend skills while deepening practical understanding of AI technologies, particularly agent-based systems and large language model integration. Demonstrated ability to rapidly prototype and deploy AI-enhanced applications that solve real user problems.

2021 - Flight Delay Prediction

Built a machine learning model to predict flight delays using aviation and weather datasets. Worked end-to-end across data ingestion, cleansing, and model deployment using Python, SQL, and Azure services. Strengthened skills in applied data science, cloud deployment, and productionising models for real-world use cases.

2020 - Personal Website - www.cosminpeste.com

Designed and developed a personal website to showcase project work and technical skills. Built using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, the site reflects a commitment to clean, functional design and serves as a central platform for professional engagement and personal exploration of web technologies.

2019 - Crime Rate Analysis

Explored crime data from major cities to uncover patterns and trends. Extracted and transformed data using SQL, with analysis and visualisation carried out in Python and Power BI. The project demonstrated a practical application of analytical thinking and data storytelling using real-world datasets.

2018 - Fantasy Football

Created a fantasy football application that aggregated and processed data from multiple sources via web scraping. Built and deployed using Python and Azure, the tool supported user decision-making through curated data outputs. This project deepened experience in automation, data cleaning, and cloud services.

Activities and Interests

Outside of work, I remain actively engaged with the technology community through personal projects and continuous learning. I regularly experiment with emerging technologies and frameworks, using side projects as opportunities to deepen my technical expertise and explore new approaches to problem solving. I also maintain an active lifestyle through tennis, which helps me stay focused and energised. I believe in balancing technical depth with broader interests, and I'm committed to staying current with industry developments while contributing to meaningful work that drives real business impact.

References available upon request.